Nomadology concepts: where they came from and how they were taken up

A concept, as Deleuze often put it, is the movement behind its name. Indeed, many of these names have changed meaning more than once. Each row gives a concept of the two plateaus in plain words, the field from which it came, where it was worked out before 1980 (CERFI's journal *Recherches* in 1972-73, Deleuze's seminars at Vincennes in 1979-80), and how it has been taken up since. R13 is *Recherches* 13 (December 1973), cited by its printed pages.

Concept	In plain words	Where it came from	Where it was worked out	How it has been taken up since
The five machinic processes 435, 437	Five coexisting processes (warding off, the war machine, capture, polarization, encompassment) that define social formations in place of modes of production	Two libraries: historians and urbanists (Braudel, Childe, Wittfogel, Mumford, Amin, Jacobs) for town, State, and ecumenical, and anthropologists (Clastres, Lévi-Strauss, Dumézil) for warding off, capture, and war machine	Guattari in 1973 on a Neolithic organization that survives "in Oriental despotism ... even in capitalism" R13 129. Deleuze in 1979: projecting one form onto another without precaution is "a catastrophe" seminar, 20 Nov 1979	*Taken for a typology of societies, or flattened into capture against escape, which drops the town and the ecumenical (Protevi's table has neither, RoV xx-xxi)*
Warding off (anticipation-prevention) 357-59, 429-33, 437-40	The ways in which a society anticipates a power it has never seen, so as to prevent it	Clastres's chief without command (*Society against the State*), Lévi-Strauss's two village plans (*Structural Anthropology* 149-51), and Mauss on the destruction of wealth	Deleuze names Mauss as the source that Clastres "took up and renewed" seminar, 20 Nov 1979. Guattari on the potlatch: "above all no reciprocity, even when there is reciprocity" R13 142	*An evolved disposition (Boehm's reverse dominance hierarchy, RoV 98), a damping mechanism (Protevi's "thick threshold"), or a costless equality*
Limit and threshold 437-41	The limit is the next-to-last, marking a fresh start for an assemblage. The threshold is the last, marking a change of assemblage	Jevons's "final degree of utility" (1871) and the marginalists Pirou and Pareto 566-67 nn. 24-26	Deleuze: "The marginal object is the penultimate or the limit" seminar, 27 Nov 1979	*Lost. Bonta and Protevi's glossary keeps the distinction but not its marginalist content*
Apparatus of capture 424-27, 444, 459-60	Direct comparison and monopolistic appropriation together, as in rent, profit, and tax	Dumézil's two-headed sovereignty (Varuna the binder, Mitra the jurist) in *Mitra-Varuna* (1948), together with the Roman debt bond called the nexum	Deleuze: "magic" was "a convenient and temporary word ... there is a war capture, but it is not at all the same as a State capture" seminar, 22 Jan 1980. Fourquet in 1972: "the first form of writing is accounting" R13 28	*Co-optation ("the system captures resistance"), or simply everything a State does*
Urstaat 359, 427, 460	The State presupposed by every account of its origin, which "comes into the world fully formed"	Marx's Asiatic mode (*Grundrisse*), Wittfogel, Childe, and Nietzsche's founders who come "like lightning" (*Genealogy* II.17)	Against it, in 1973: "we will have learned nothing from knowing that this State was already in germ in Sumer or in Egypt" R13 116	*Taken for a historical despotism, or for an origin*
Polarization (the town) 432-35	The town as a point on circuits of roads, a power "of the middle" that coordinates by force	Fourquet and Murard's 1976 *Les équipements du pouvoir* ("The Facilities of Power"), along with Braudel's "two runners, the state and the town" and Lévi-Strauss's village plans	Towns "always emerge as a network" before any territorial State, as with the Hanse R13 70-71, 89-92. Deleuze: "a bureaucracy of networks" seminar, 20 Nov 1979	*Almost absent from the reception, and near zero in Protevi*
Encompassment (the ecumenical) 435-36, 454	Organizations that pass through heterogeneous formations at once (trade, religions, art)	Samir Amin's *Unequal Development* (146, 295), Braudel's world-economy, and Lacarrière on the desert fathers	Islam as "an immense network," whose first public facilities were "language, money ... and religion" R13 77-79	*Almost absent, with world-systems theory taken up in its place*
Code, overcoding, axiomatic 427, 448-54, 461-62	Among the Tiv, it was good to trade food for brass rods and bad to do the reverse, while land could not be traded at all because the right to it came from descent. Such a ranking is a code, because it treats the rank of a thing as a fact about that thing that no trade can change. Overcoding keeps such codes in force but makes them answer to a higher authority, as when a king rules over communities that go on following their own customs. In contrast to code, axioms are what drive systems far more abstracted from social worlds, such as economic models adding or subtracting functions to optimize for a certain output. Assigning no rank to anything, they make no claim about truth or existence.	Lévi-Strauss's codes of exchange, the genetic code (Jacob and Monod), Hjelmslev, and set theory	Guattari in 1973: "public facilities are the axioms of capital ... no intrinsic coding" R13 131	*Confused with computer code, which is neither a code nor an axiom in their sense until a business or a State puts it to work, at which point it usually serves axioms.*
Adding axioms 462-63, 470	Capitalism's answer to whatever escapes it, which is to add an axiom for it	Set theory and Marxist accounts of co-optation	Guattari in 1973: capital is "obliged to enlarge its own axiomatic without stopping" and "the first axiom of capital is recuperation" R13 133, 140	*Folded into capture as co-optation, with recuperation as fate, though ATP calls recuperation a "disenchanted concept" (463)*
The stock 440-44	What begins when exchange stops being of interest, with land, tools, and money as stockpiled territory, activity, and exchange	Ingold on social storage (1983), Testart (1982), and Jacobs and Mellaart on Çatal Hüyük	The State as "a social machine ... for putting flows in reserve" R13 72	*Storage as a threshold toward the State (Sterelny, in RoV 98)*
Nomad and nomos 380-85, 422	The nomad inhabits a space without dividing it. The nomos is a distribution "without division into shares"	Toynbee's nomads who "stood their ground," Laroche on the root *nem-* 557 n. 51 against Schmitt's nomos as land seizure, and Ibn Khaldun	Deleuze: there are "nomades sur place" ("nomads on the spot") seminar, 25 Mar 1980	*A people of the steppe, mobility, flight, the digital nomad, Braidotti's nomadic subject*

Nomadology concepts, continued

Concepts 13-24, from nomad and nomos to the right of use.

Concept	In plain words	Where it came from	Where it was worked out	How it has been taken up since
Holey space 413-15	Space bored through mountain and subsoil by the smith, communicating with both smooth and striated space	Élie Faure on the rock-cut temples of India, Eisenstein's *Strike*, and Childe and Griaule on smiths	The vacant lot, or terrain vague ("waste ground"), as a modern holey remainder R13 173-74	*Ignored, Protevi included*
Line of flight (the leak) 204, 216, 229	From the French fuite, which is also a leak: to put a system to flight is to make it leak	French fuite ("leak," "flight") and painting's point de fuite ("vanishing point"), Anglo-American literature, George Jackson	"To put a system to flight as one bursts a tube" *Dialogues* 36. In 1973: "it leaks on all sides" R13 118-19	*Flight as leaving, exodus, or refuge (Protevi's "autonomy-seeking flight / refuge")*
War machine 351-423	A process whose positive object is to compose a smooth space and its people, with war only as its supplement	Dumézil on the warrior's exteriority, Clausewitz, Ibn Khaldun, Clastres, de Heusch, Brossollet, Virilio, Kleist	Guattari in 1972: "The ideal of despotism is Genghis Khan: destroy everything (except the artisans)" R13 29, and in 1973 "nomadic State power" R13 135	*Militarism, "the nomads" (Sneath, Munkh-Erdene), creativity in general, or any subversive collective*
Numbering number 387-94	A number that distributes people in space and moves with them, articulated and doubled by a special body	Kristeva's *Semeiotike* (293-97), Aristotle's counting number (*Physics* IV.11), the muster of Numbers 1, and Jethro's judges in Exodus 18	Deleuze on Boulez: "cipher, numbering number, nomad or Mallarmean number"	*Little used, and taken by the specialists for sovereignty*
Esprit de corps 366	A solidarity that makes the family "a band vector instead of a fundamental cell"	Ibn Khaldun's asabiyya (*The Muqaddimah*)	·	*Team spirit (Protevi's chapter on team sports, RoV 73-88)*
The secret, the cipher 390, 286-90	The cipher "invents the secret and its outgrowths," against the public knowledge of the State	Simmel on secret societies, de Heusch's man of war, and for today the anthropology of restricted knowledge (Price, Bilby, Peterson, Myers)	Deleuze in 1972: codes work by "zones of secrecy," an axiomatic by "objective concealment" seminar, 7 Mar 1972	*Knowledge treated as one more stock for capture*
Nomad and royal science 361-74, 461	Two conceptions of science in one field, the one following a material and the other reproducing a form	Serres on Lucretius, Husserl's vague essences (*Ideas* I §74), Bachelard, Simondon, Vergez on the compagnonnages, Lautman	Querrien's *Devenir fonctionnaire* (1977). Guattari in 1973: "Bourbaki is a capitalist theorist" R13 145	*Unused by Protevi, and otherwise taken as complexity theory (Bonta and Protevi) or as Indigenous or alternative knowledge*
Minority, the nondenumerable 469-71	A set defined by the relations internal to its number, which no axiom can count	Cantor's set theory and Yann Moulier-Boutang	Guattari in 1973: "a special axiom ... for the Katangans, as long as it does not leak anywhere" R13 138	*Minor as small or marginal*
Machinic enslavement and social subjection 456-60	People as parts of a machine, against people as subjects who use a machine	Mumford's megamachine, Reuleaux, Marx on constant and variable capital, and cybernetics	The city as "the social cybernetic machine of industrial capitalism" (1971) R13 20 n. 1	*Taken up for digital capitalism (Lazzarato), rarely for slavery*
Machinic phylum 404-15	Matter in movement and variation, carrying singularities and traits of expression, which can only be followed	Simondon, Childe on metallurgy, and Hjelmslev	Guattari in 1973: the phylum as "the most deterritorialized point" R13 131	·
Public facilities behind 454, 461-62	Schools, hospitals, roads, and other such facilities, which Guattari called "the axioms of capital" (not an ATP term)	French postwar planning, where équipements collectifs ("public facilities") enters the Fourth Plan in 1962	Facilities as "instruments of domination and territorial fixing of flows" R13 127	*Translated "collective equipment," and confused with infrastructure*
Channeled nomadism, the right of use not in ATP, cf. 386	The highway channels nomadism, while public service implies a general nomadism, so that "the right of use is the community"	French public service law, with its usager ("user") and droit d'usage ("right of use")	Deleuze in the CERFI discussion of public facilities R13 186	*Unknown to the reception*

ATP page numbers refer to the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987), RoV to Protevi's *Regimes of Violence* (2025). Seminar dates refer to the Purdue transcripts of Deleuze's lectures. Translations from the French are the project's own. Source: *kit/concept_ledger.tsv*.